BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #56 · PHYSICAL DIFFERENCES

“I have to hide my difference to be accepted.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A birthmark, scar, limb difference, stutter, or other visible or hidden difference can lead to covering up, avoiding photos, or staying out of view. The effort is exhausting and can reinforce shame.

What Scripture teaches

“I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” “Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?” God is not embarrassed by how He made you. “The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor.” Real acceptance does not require hiding. Choose to share at your own pace with safe people.

> *“I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well”* (Psalm 139:14).

Also see

> “And the LORD said to him, ‘Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?’” (Exodus 4:11).

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it” (1 Corinthians 12:22–24).

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7).

> “Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: ‘Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!’” (Isaiah 43:1).

Common self-statements

- I must cover it.
- If they see it, they will reject me.
- I cannot be photographed.
- I have to explain it.
- I must keep it hidden.
- My difference is shameful.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either hidden and accepted or exposed and rejected.
- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection if people see.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling shame and concluding I must hide.
- Labeling: Calling my difference shameful.

Challenging questions

- What do I hide, and what does hiding cost me?
- Who has seen it and still accepted me?
- What does God say about how He made me?
- What if I shared with one safe person?
- What response would I like to practice if someone asks?
- What parts of my difference are also a strength?

Truth summary

> God made me as I am, and He is not ashamed of me. I can share at my own pace with safe people, and I do not need to hide to be loved.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Guilt/Shame
- God, Creator
- Pride
- Confession

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I have to hide my difference to be accepted"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have to hide my difference to be accepted." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I hide, and what does hiding cost me?
- ☐ Who has seen it and still accepted me?
- ☐ What does God say about how He made me?
- ☐ What if I shared with one safe person?
- ☐ What response would I like to practice if someone asks?
- ☐ What parts of my difference are also a strength?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God made every body.
- ☐ Weaker parts are honored.
- ☐ I do not need to hide.
- ☐ Safe people accept me.
- ☐ I choose how and when to share.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 139:14**
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **Exodus 4:11**
  "And the LORD said to him, 'Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?'"
- ☐ **1 Corinthians 12:22–24**
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Less hiding: Each week, note one small step toward openness.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 139:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made me as I am and is not ashamed of me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Guilt/Shame" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Count the cost. Write what hiding costs.
- [ ] Choose a safe person. Share with one.
- [ ] Practice a short answer. Prepare for questions.
- [ ] Read Psalm 139. Let it speak.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have to hide my difference to be accepted": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Less hiding
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have to hide my difference to be accepted.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Creator, You made me as I am. Free me from shame, and give me safe people and courage to be open at my own pace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“People see my difference before they see me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

First impressions are fast and often shaped by what is visible. Repeated experiences of being pigeonholed lead us to expect it always.

What Scripture teaches

God said to Samuel, “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” Jesus saw people as individuals: Bartimaeus, a blind beggar, was called by name and asked, “What do you want Me to do for you?” (Mark 10:51). “Stop judging by outward appearances, and start judging justly” (John 7:24). Some people will notice first and then look deeper. Others will meet you directly, and over time, those who matter see the whole you.

> *“But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’”* (1 Samuel 16:7).

Also see

> “Next, they came to Jericho. And as Jesus and His disciples were leaving Jericho with a large crowd, a blind beggar named Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, was sitting beside the road” (Mark 10:46).

> “Stop judging by outward appearances, and start judging justly” (John 7:24).

> “Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: ‘Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!’” (Isaiah 43:1).

> “O LORD, You have searched me and known me” (Psalm 139:1).

Common self-statements

- It is all they see.
- I will always be defined by it.
- They never see the real me.
- First impressions are final.
- I am a walking difference.
- No one gets past it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people see only my difference or only me.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will never look deeper.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling noticed and concluding I am defined.
- Mind reading: Calling myself my difference.

Challenging questions

- Who has looked past my difference?
- What do I want people to know first?

- How do I introduce myself?
- What does it feel like when someone sees me fully?
- What does God see?
- What conversation starters let people see more of me?

Truth summary

> God sees my heart, and many people will, too. I can guide first impressions by sharing what matters about me, and I can seek those who look deeper.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Judgmental
- Prejudice
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "People see my difference before they see me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People see my difference before they see me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has looked past my difference?
- ☐ What do I want people to know first?
- ☐ How do I introduce myself?
- ☐ What does it feel like when someone sees me fully?
- ☐ What does God see?
- ☐ What conversation starters let people see more of me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord sees my heart.
- ☐ Jesus saw individuals.
- ☐ Many people look deeper.
- ☐ I can lead with who I am.
- ☐ I am known by name.
- ☐ I am more than my difference.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ Mark 10:46
  "Next, they came to Jericho. And as Jesus and His disciples were leaving Jericho with a large crowd, a blind beggar named Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, was sitting beside the road."
- ☐ John 7:24
  "Stop judging by outward appearances, and start judging justly."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Seen for me: Each week, note one person who saw more than your difference.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Samuel 16:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord sees my heart.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Judgmental" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Plan an intro. Share an interest or strength early.
- [ ] Thank deep seers. Tell someone they see you.
- [ ] Join an interest group. Meet people around shared passions.
- [ ] Read Mark 10:46–52. Notice how Jesus engaged.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People see my difference before they see me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Seen for me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People see my difference before they see me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, people notice my difference first. Thank You that You see my heart. Give me friends who see all of me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“I'll always be the odd one out.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A lifetime of being the one who looks, moves, or sounds different can create the expectation that groups will never fully include us.

What Scripture teaches

“God settles the lonely in families.” “From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part.” “Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good.” God’s family includes people of every kind, and the body needs your part. Some groups are not welcoming, but others are. You do not have to be the same to belong.

> *“Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good”* (1 Corinthians 12:7).

Also see

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

> “From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part” (Ephesians 4:16).

> “Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function, so in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another. We have different gifts according to the grace given us. If one’s gift is prophecy, let him use it in proportion to his faith” (Romans 12:4–6).

> “There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus” (Galatians 3:28).

Common self-statements

- I never fit.
- Everyone else matches.
- I will always stand out.
- I am the exception.
- Groups will always push me out.
- I will never belong.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either fit perfectly or am an outsider.
- Fortune telling: Predicting permanent exclusion.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding I do not belong.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself the odd one.

Challenging questions

- Where have I felt included, even once?
- What did those groups value?

- Where are others like me?
- What gift do I bring that others do not?
- What does Scripture say about the body?
- What group could I try?

Truth summary

> I belong to God's family, and the body needs me as I am. I can look for welcoming groups, bring my gifts, and make room for others who feel different.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Prejudice

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll always be the odd one out"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll always be the odd one out." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where have I felt included, even once?
- ☐ What did those groups value?
- ☐ Where are others like me?
- ☐ What gift do I bring that others do not?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the body?
- ☐ What group could I try?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ Every part is needed.
- ☐ I have a gift for the common good.
- ☐ There is no division in Christ.
- ☐ Welcoming groups exist.
- ☐ I can make room for others.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:7
  "Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good."
- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."
- ☐ Ephesians 4:16
  "From Him the whole body, fitted and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love through the work of each individual part."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Belonging: Each week, note one welcoming moment.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 12:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Every part of the body is needed, including me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Recall belonging. Write where you felt included.
- [ ] Find your people. Seek groups with shared interests.
- [ ] Offer a gift. Contribute something small.
- [ ] Welcome another. Include someone who looks left out.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll always be the odd one out": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Belonging
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
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Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll always be the odd one out.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel like the odd one out. Place me in a family where I belong, use my gifts, and help me welcome others. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“I'll never fit in.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Repeated experiences of exclusion or teasing create a lasting expectation that fitting in is impossible. We may stop trying or adopt a defensive stance.

What Scripture teaches

Paul wrote that in Christ “there is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus.” “Now you are the body of Christ, and each of you is a member of it” (1 Corinthians 12:27). You are not asked to fit a mold; you are asked to be part of a family. “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.” Some places never will fit; others will. Fitting in can be less important than being known and loved.

> *“There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus”* (Galatians 3:28).

Also see

> “The body is a unit, though it is composed of many parts. And although its parts are many, they all form one body. So it is with Christ” (1 Corinthians 12:12).

> “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another” (Proverbs 27:17).

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

> “So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another” (Romans 12:5).

Common self-statements

- No group will take me.
- I am not like others.
- I will always be outside.
- Trying is pointless.
- I do not have what it takes.
- I am too different.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either fit in or never will.
- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling out of place and concluding it is permanent.
- Overgeneralizing: Calling myself unfit.

Challenging questions

- What do I mean by “fit in”?
- Would I rather fit in or be known?
- Who knows me and accepts me now?

- What settings suit me?
- What does Scripture say about unity and diversity?
- What is one small step toward connection?

Truth summary

> I may never match every group, and I do not need to. I am one in Christ, part of His body, and I can seek the kind of connection where I am known and loved.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Church
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Worldly

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

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God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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My Plan for Replacing "I'll never fit in"

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Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll never fit in." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I mean by "fit in"?
- ☐ Would I rather fit in or be known?
- ☐ Who knows me and accepts me now?
- ☐ What settings suit me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about unity and diversity?
- ☐ What is one small step toward connection?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am one in Christ.
- ☐ I am part of the body of Christ.
- ☐ Friends sharpen friends.
- ☐ God places the lonely in families.
- ☐ Being known matters more than fitting in.
- ☐ I can take a step.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 3:28
  "There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:12
  "The body is a unit, though it is composed of many parts. And although its parts are many, they all form one body. So it is with Christ."
- ☐ Proverbs 27:17
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Known and accepted: Each week, note one place where you felt known.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 3:28 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am one in Christ and part of His body.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Friendship" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Define belonging. Write what you want from a group.
- [ ] Seek depth over breadth. Aim for a few real friendships.
- [ ] Try a small group. Bible study or hobby club.
- [ ] Read Galatians 3:28. Remember your unity in Christ.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never fit in": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Known and accepted
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never fit in.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have never fit. Make me part of Your family, give me a few true friends, and help me be at peace with myself. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #60 · PHYSICAL DIFFERENCES

“Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Difference is often treated as deficiency, by media, peers, and sometimes medical language. Children especially take this in as fact about themselves.

What Scripture teaches

God said, “Let Us make man in Our image” (Genesis 1:26). Every person is a unique image-bearer. “God looked upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good.” “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb.” “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor.” Variation in the human family is part of creation. You are not wrong, and you do not have to match anyone.

> *“And God looked upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good. And there was evening, and there was morning—the sixth day”* (Genesis 1:31).

Also see

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb” (Psalm 139:13).

> “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:5).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- I am wrong.
- Normal looks are right.
- I was made badly.
- I am a mistake.
- There must be something wrong with me.
- I do not belong in the human family.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing there is a right way to look and I do not match.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be seen as wrong.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I am wrong.
- Labeling: Calling myself wrong.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that different means wrong?
- What does Scripture say God thought of what He made?
- What is beautiful about variety?

- Who celebrates my uniqueness?
- How can I speak kindly about my body?
- What would I tell a child who looks like me?

Truth summary

> I am not wrong. I am made in God's image and called very good. Variety is part of creation, and I can embrace who I am.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame
- Prejudice
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me that different means wrong?
- ☐ What does Scripture say God thought of what He made?
- ☐ What is beautiful about variety?
- ☐ Who celebrates my uniqueness?
- ☐ How can I speak kindly about my body?
- ☐ What would I tell a child who looks like me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God called His creation very good.
- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ God knit me together.
- ☐ I am crowned with glory and honor.
- ☐ Variety is part of creation.
- ☐ I am not wrong.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Genesis 1:31
  "And God looked upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good. And there was evening, and there was morning—the sixth day."
- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ Psalm 139:13
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Called good: Each day, say one thing about yourself that is true and good.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Genesis 1:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God called all He made very good.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Note the source. Write who taught you different is wrong.
- ☐ Speak kindly. Replace "wrong" with "different."
- ☐ Seek affirmation. Spend time with people who celebrate you.
- ☐ Read Genesis 1. Note "very good."

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Called good
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Creator, You called what You made very good. Heal the hurt of being told I am wrong, and help me see myself as You do. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.